

Britney Tops Search Again

For the third time in four years, Britney Spears claimed the title of most searched-for person on the Web in 2004, according to tallies by America Online. The highest-ranked movies were *Harry Potter*, *The Passion of the Christ* and *Lord of the Rings*.



Robo Sapiens!

Researchers in South Korea have developed a humanoid robot that responds to human voices and can speak. HUBO can walk slowly, and can move five fingers. The HUBO research group has spent three years and about \$1 million developing the robot.



Escape

POP GOES THE AD

1 In 20 Do Not Mind Pop-Ups!

Surprise! Surprise! According to a recent survey by useit.com's Jakob Nielsen, 95 per cent of

Some of the survey results are published here.

The figures, to say the least, are intriguing. If only 93 per cent of respondents responded "negatively" or "very negatively" to ads that do not have a "close" button, it has to be concluded that the remaining seven per cent either enjoyed random ads on their screen with no close button, or, interestingly, were neutral to them. What kind of idle surfers are these?

Also, it seems from the table that 21 per cent of users are, again, either positive or neutral about ads that float across the screen. Now that is a large number!

users hate pop-up ads. Surveys of this kind have been done before, but none have approached the kind of accuracy that Nielsen has in this latest survey.

Ad Design Element	Users who disliked it (%)
Pops-up in front of your window	95
Loads slowly	94
Tries to trick you into clicking on it	94
Does not have a "Close" button	93
Covers what you are trying to see	93
Moves content around	92
Occupies most of the page	90
Blinks on and off	87
Floats across the screen	79

THE SITE THAT CRIED WOLF

Bush Arrested

Google News recently featured a top story that Canada had arrested US President George W Bush in Ottawa and that he was charged with war crimes. No, really!

Well, what happened was that the source was a satire site called Axis of Logic, and Google's crawlers listed the news story missing out on the fact that it was from a satire site. Since it was up there on Google News, the obvious question is whether anybody believed the story. Apparently, some did. There were a few postings on some groups by people who believed it.

UNUSABLE!



microsoft.com/india/windowsxp/

What would you do if you wanted to purchase, online, a copy of Windows XP? Head to Microsoft India's site, of course. But at the page mentioned above, for some reason, when you click "How To Buy", you are taken to the Volume Licensing Home Page. This includes "Licensing Overview", "Software Assurance", and other such stuff. *I just want a single copy, dammit!* But there's no way you can get a copy of Windows XP from this site.

One poster asked, "Don't these Canadians realise that we saved their a** in the last two World Wars?" Going further, one concerned woman even asked if there was someplace she could send money to help bail out the Prez!

Just one of the perils of living in a world where machines do everything for you.

RIVALS IN LOVE

Firefox Loves Microsoft

It's Google's fault again, I really. Read on. In the Firefox browser, when you type in a double http://, such

Win!

My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? Send it to **mydesktop@thinkdigit.com**, and Digit will publish the most eye-catching of them each month.



The winner will receive a KUSBDT1/128FE USB stick worth Rs 1,300. This month's winner is **C. Prakash**.

Sponsored by



WE SURRENDER: Prakash's desktop makes us throw away our guns in fear!
Sent by C. Prakash